

Final Expense Life Insurance

The Most Frank Guide You'll Ever Read on This Product

From a 25-year U.S. field veteran: what final expense is, how to sell it ethically, what the industry doesn't tell you, and how to protect your clients and your commissions.

Doc: 05 | *Final Expense Brief* | U.S. Medicare Agents | AEP 2026 | **Brand:** AgentRisePro / 121 Urban Media LLC | **Audience:** U.S. Medicare Agents & Beneficiaries Only

■ KILL SWITCH — VERIFY BEFORE EVERY USE

- Final expense is NOT a Medicare product. Never imply CMS, SSA, or government affiliation.
- Average U.S. funeral cost: \$9,000–\$12,000+ (NFDA 2023). Verify current data at [nfda.org](https://www.nfda.org) annually.
- Louisiana replacement rules: La. R.S. 22:901 et seq. Texas: 28 TAC Chapter 10. Verify your state DOI.
- Guaranteed Issue waiting period is typically 2 years. Disclose this clearly and completely at every appointment.
- FTC Do Not Call rules apply to all outbound prospecting. Violations carry substantial civil penalties.
- Life insurance license required in every U.S. state where you sell. Keep CE current per your state DOI.

"I've been in this business 25 years. Final expense is the product that protects families at their most vulnerable moment. That is not a sales line — that is the truth. When you approach it that way, when you genuinely believe that, clients feel it. And they buy from you."

WHAT FINAL EXPENSE INSURANCE ACTUALLY IS

Final expense insurance is a whole life policy designed specifically to cover end-of-life costs — funeral, burial, cremation, outstanding medical bills, and small debts. Face amounts typically range from \$2,000 to \$50,000. Premiums are level — they never increase for the life of the policy. Coverage is permanent — it does not expire as long as premiums are paid. And it is simplified issue — meaning no physical examination is required, just health questions (or none at all, in the case of Guaranteed Issue products).

- SEASONED AGENT TIP: Lead with the mission, not the product. 'I help families make sure they're not left with an unexpected bill during the worst week of their life.' That's your conversation opener. Not: 'I sell final expense insurance.' One opens a heart. The other opens a door — to the next house.

THE THREE PRODUCT TIERS — KNOW WHERE YOUR CLIENT BELONGS

Tier	Underwriting	Death Benefit	Ideal Client Profile
Level / Preferred	Health questions; possible Rx database check; no physical exam	Full death benefit from day 1	Generally healthy; controlled chronic conditions (diabetes, hypertension)
Graded Benefit	Fewer health questions; select conditions accepted	Partial payout years 1-2 (e.g., 30-70%); full benefit from year 3	Moderate health issues; cannot qualify for Level coverage
Guaranteed Issue (GI)	No health questions. No exam. Guaranteed acceptance.	Return of premium + interest years 1-2; full death benefit from year 3	Serious health conditions. Absolute last resort — only when no other tier is available.

■ **FIELD WARNING:** Always place a client in the BEST tier they qualify for — not the easiest tier to write. Placing a healthy client in Guaranteed Issue when they qualify for Level coverage is not in their interest. It benefits the agent's ease of sale at the client's expense. Don't do it. It's an ethical violation and a suitability issue.

WHAT THE FIELD ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE — WHAT NOBODY TELLS NEW AGENTS

The poaching problem is real — and it costs agents money

This happens more than the industry admits. A client calls their carrier with a question and gets connected to a different agent who re-writes the policy under their own writing number. If the switch processes before December 31, the new agent typically receives the commission. If the original agent catches it within a few days of submission, the policy may revert. If it surfaces after AEP, commissions may split between the two agents. The lesson: stay close to your book. Set calendar reminders around renewal dates. Be the agent they call first — before they call the carrier.

NIGO will kill your commission check

NIGO stands for Not In Good Order. Every U.S. carrier has a NIGO policy — if your paperwork contains errors, missing fields, incorrect dates, or unsigned sections, the application is returned for correction. This delays placement, delays commission, and can cost you the client if they cool off while you're chasing a correction. Build a submission checklist and use it on every single application. Check it twice before you leave the appointment. Check it again before you submit.

Own your route and your schedule

Time is your inventory. Plan your appointments around traffic — not against it. High-traffic hours burn your day and make you show up flustered. Always plan to arrive early. And always plan for appointments to run long — because they will. People get chummy with the person they're about to spend money with. That chumminess is not a problem. It's relationship equity. Just build the buffer into your schedule so you're never rushing.

All roads lead to your niche

Everything you do in your business — every referral conversation, every birthday card, every magnet on a refrigerator, every calendar on a kitchen wall — is a path leading back to the Medicare Advantage doorway or back to final expense. Never waste a touchpoint. Every connection is a future opportunity to be their agent when the moment comes.

YOUR CLIENT RETENTION SYSTEM — THE RELATIONSHIP IS THE SALE

In a saturated U.S. insurance market, the agent who stays in front of their clients between sales wins the renewals, the referrals, and the upgrades. Build a touchpoint system and work it without exception.

Tool	Purpose	Timing
Business card magnet	Stays on their fridge — daily brand visibility at zero cost	Every appointment
Tap-to-download NFC card	Instant contact save directly to their phone	Every new contact
Laminated info card	Quick reference card they keep for years	Mail or hand-deliver
Birthday card	Personal connection; soft referral opportunity	Annual — every client
Policy anniversary card	Reminds them you're watching their coverage	Annual
Holiday card	Top of mind during the buying season	Seasonal
Desk calendar	365 days of brand presence in their home or office	Year-end gift
Annual review call	Referral conversation framed as a service call	Every AEP

"When you see them again, all they need is a little reminding. They will buy it. You just want to be sure they make that purchase with you."

OBJECTION HANDLING — THE REAL ANSWERS FROM THE FIELD

"I can't afford it."

Break it down to daily cost. Most final expense policies run less than \$2 a day. Then ask: 'If something happened to you tomorrow, who would your family call? And who would pay for it?' Let the silence do the work. That question answers itself.

"I already have life insurance."

Don't take that at face value — verify it. Employer group life ends when employment ends. Term policies expire. Old whole life policies may have lapsed. Ask to see the paperwork. More often than not, there's a gap. That gap is your opportunity to protect them.

"I need to think about it."

Honor it — then find the real objection. 'Of course. What specifically would help you feel comfortable moving forward?' Most of the time, 'I need to think about it' means 'I have a question I haven't asked yet.' Give them the space to ask it.

"I'm too sick to qualify."

This is exactly where Guaranteed Issue becomes a lifeline. No health questions. No physical exam. Guaranteed acceptance. The only limitation is the 2-year waiting period — which you must disclose clearly, completely, and in writing. No exceptions.

"I'll just pre-pay my funeral home."

Pre-need funeral plans are funeral-home specific and may not transfer if the funeral home closes, is sold, or if the family relocates. Final expense cash value belongs to the beneficiary — it's completely flexible and can be used for anything the family needs. That flexibility has real value.

COMPLIANCE — PROTECT YOURSELF AS MUCH AS YOUR CLIENTS

- Final expense is a state-regulated life insurance product. It is NOT a Medicare product. Never imply any connection to CMS, Medicare, or the federal government.
- U.S. replacement rules: Most states require specific forms when replacing existing life insurance. Know your state's rules. Louisiana agents: La. R.S. 22:901. Texas agents: 28 TAC Chapter 10.
- Suitability documentation: Can the client afford the premium without financial hardship? Document your needs analysis at every appointment. This protects you and your client.
- Do Not Call compliance: Scrub against the FTC/FCC National Do Not Call Registry before any outbound prospecting. Violations carry civil penalties of over \$50,000 per incident.
- Application accuracy: Intentional misrepresentation on a life insurance application is grounds for claim denial at death — often when the family needs the money most. Complete every application accurately. Always.
- Licensing: Active life insurance license required in every state where you sell. Keep continuing education current per your state DOI requirements.

"Your license is your livelihood. Protect it like the asset it is. One compliance shortcut, one application error left uncorrected — that's how long careers end badly. Do it right every time. Every single time."

VERIFIED U.S. RESOURCES & CITATIONS

NFDA — U.S. Funeral Cost Statistics

<https://nfda.org/news/statistics>

Annual U.S. funeral cost data. Kill Switch: Verify annually before discussing face amount needs.

Louisiana DOI — Life Division

<https://www.lidi.la.gov/consumers/life-health>

LA replacement forms, agent licensing requirements, and consumer complaint resources.

Texas DOI — Life Insurance

<https://www.tdi.texas.gov/life/index.html>

TX life insurance rules, replacement regulations, and agent licensing.

NAIC Life Insurance Replacement Model Regulation

<https://content.naic.org/sites/default/files/inline-files/MDL-613.pdf>

The model regulation underlying most U.S. state replacement rules.

FTC Telemarketing Sales Rule

<https://www.ftc.gov/legal-library/browse/rules/telemarketing-sales-rule>

U.S. Do Not Call and telemarketing compliance requirements for outbound prospecting.

YOUR NEXT STEP: AgentRisePro

The Medicare Agent Workspace built by a 25-year U.S. Medicare field veteran — for U.S. agents who are serious about AEP.

AGENT PILOT \$38/month	AGENT PRO \$68/month	AGENCY \$83/month
Solo independent agent AEP launch special	Full features + Voice AI when live	Multi-agent teams White label ready
Script Desk Launch Kit Calendar Basic CRM	Everything in Pilot + GPT Voice (coming) + Advanced CRM + Carrier Tools	Everything in Pro + Team Dashboard + Agency Reporting + Priority Support
Annual: \$368/yr (Save \$88 — 2 mo free)	Annual: \$658/yr (Save \$158 — 2 mo free)	Annual: \$803/yr (Save \$193 — 2 mo free)

- Script Desk — Medicare scripts by product & situation
- Agent Launch Kit — all 5 briefs + 100+ questions
- Fresh Pour — agent community & audio lounge
- Training Calendar — built-in appointment by block
- Book of Business CRM — track your U.S. agents
- GPT Voice AI — hands-free in the car (coming Q1 2027)
- Download & share tools
- U.S. carrier reference library
- CMS compliance reminders built in

■ 7-DAY FREE TRIAL — NO CREDIT CARD REQUIRED

Try the full app free for 7 days. No obligation. No credit card. Cancel anytime. Pilot pricing locked in for early adopters during AEP 2026. Download the Medicare Advantage Launch Blueprint PDF for just \$4.99 — or get it FREE with your 7-day trial.

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